CheckIn

Daily Work Report — Live Email, Account Clean-up & Email Design

Student Attendance System · IDE201 Capstone · Group 2 · College of Science and Technology

Contributor	Ugyen Norbu (GitHub: UgayNobu) — repository owner, deployment
Date	Thursday 29 – Friday 30 October 2026
Repository	github.com/UgayNobu/Checkin (branches: dev and main)
Pull requests	#61 Brevo email (dev) · #62 into main · #63 email design (dev) · #64 into main

1. Summary

Sanskar reported that the forgot-password code never arrived. I traced it to three separate problems and fixed all of them. Email from the live site now works: reset codes, low-attendance alerts, absence-request results and password-change notices all reach the inbox. I also gave every email a proper CheckIn design.

3	2	4	11	43
causes found and fixed	fake accounts removed	pull requests merged	new unit tests	backend tests pass

2. Why the reset code did not arrive

#	Cause	Fix
1	**Fake account email.** Sanskar's test account 12345678 used a made-up student number, so its email 12345678.cst@rub.edu.bt does not exist.	Deleted the fake accounts (section 3). He signs up again with his real number.
2	**Render blocks email ports.** Render's free plan blocks the SMTP ports (25, 465, 587), so Gmail could not send anything from the live backend.	Emails now go through Brevo's email API over HTTPS (section 4).
3	**Missing database table.** The live backend crashed with "The table public.password_resets does not exist" (Render log, error P2021). Part 7 of database.sql had never been run on Supabase.	Created the table in the Supabase SQL editor and checked that all 19 tables the app uses exist.

Locally everything had worked, because our test database had the table and laptops are allowed to use Gmail SMTP. Only the live site was affected.

3. Account clean-up (Supabase)

A read-only check listed every account and marked its email as real (college), fake or to check. The clean-up then ran in one transaction with a safety check, so nothing would change if the accounts were not exactly as expected.

Removed	Reason
U004 — Test Student 01	Email test.student01@example.com does not exist
12345678 — sanskar gurung	Made-up student number, so the email does not exist

Kept: CST-ICT01 (admin), CST-MGT01 (management), CST-0142 and CST-0143 (tutors), 02240357 and 02250144 (students).

- **Still to check:** whether ict@cst.edu.bt and management@cst.edu.bt are real inboxes, and whether 02250144's email should include ".cst".

4. Email on the live site (Brevo)

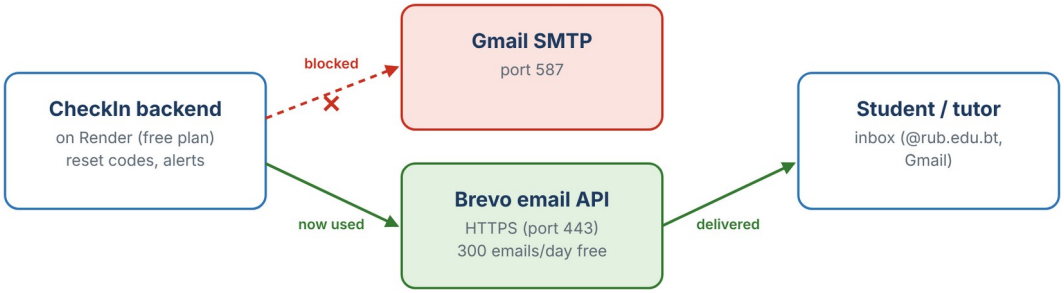
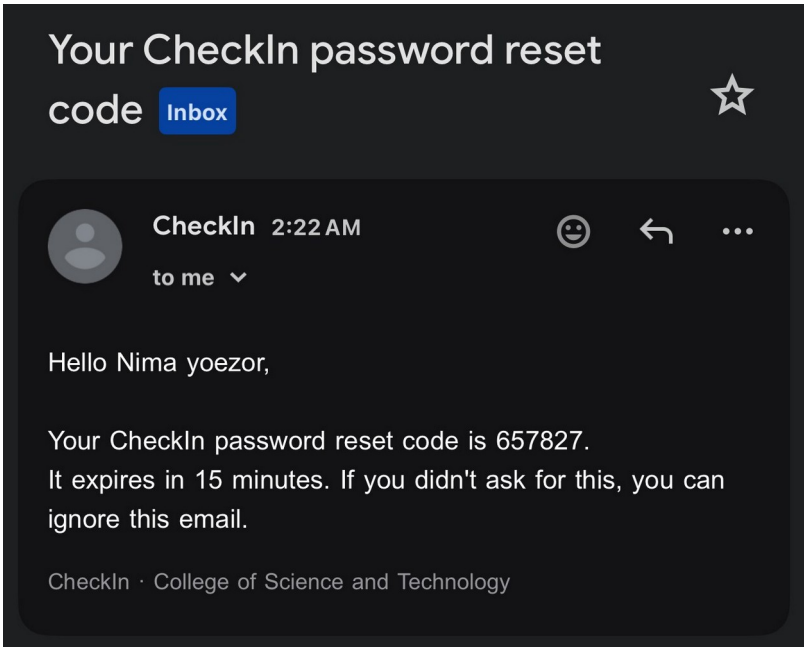


Figure 1 — the live backend now sends through Brevo's HTTPS API instead of Gmail SMTP

- **Code:** backend/src/lib/mailer.js uses Brevo when BREVO_API_KEY is set, otherwise Gmail SMTP as before, so laptops keep working unchanged. Clear error messages for a wrong key or an unverified sender.
- **Brevo:** free plan (300 emails a day). Sender CheckIn CST <02240369.cst@rub.edu.bt> verified. API key restricted to transactional email (all) and account (read only).
- **Render:** BREVO_API_KEY and MAIL_FROM added as environment settings, never in the code.
- **Tested:** 7 unit tests with a fake Brevo (no real email sent), then a real reset code on the live site arrived in the Inbox, not Spam.



The first reset code from the live site

Emails the system sends

When	To	Subject
Forgot password	User	Your CheckIn password reset code
Password reset / changed	User	Your CheckIn password was reset / changed
Attendance below 90% in a module	Student	Low attendance in MODULE
Same check, list per module	Tutor	Attendance shortage in MODULE
Absence request decided	Student and tutor	Absence request approved / rejected
Tutor account approved or created	Tutor	Your CheckIn tutor account is approved / ready

Everything else (flagged check-ins, cover requests, module changes) appears only in the bell inside the app. Students can turn emails off in Settings.

5. New email design

All emails now share one layout, built with tables and inline styles so they look the same in Gmail, Outlook and phone apps:

- Navy CheckIn header with the CST logo, and “Hello NAME,” on every email.
- Reset codes shown large in their own box; an “Open CheckIn” button to the live site.
- Footer with the college name and a note that it is an automatic message.
- A plain-text copy for mail apps without HTML. Names and messages are escaped, so no HTML can be injected (4 new unit tests).

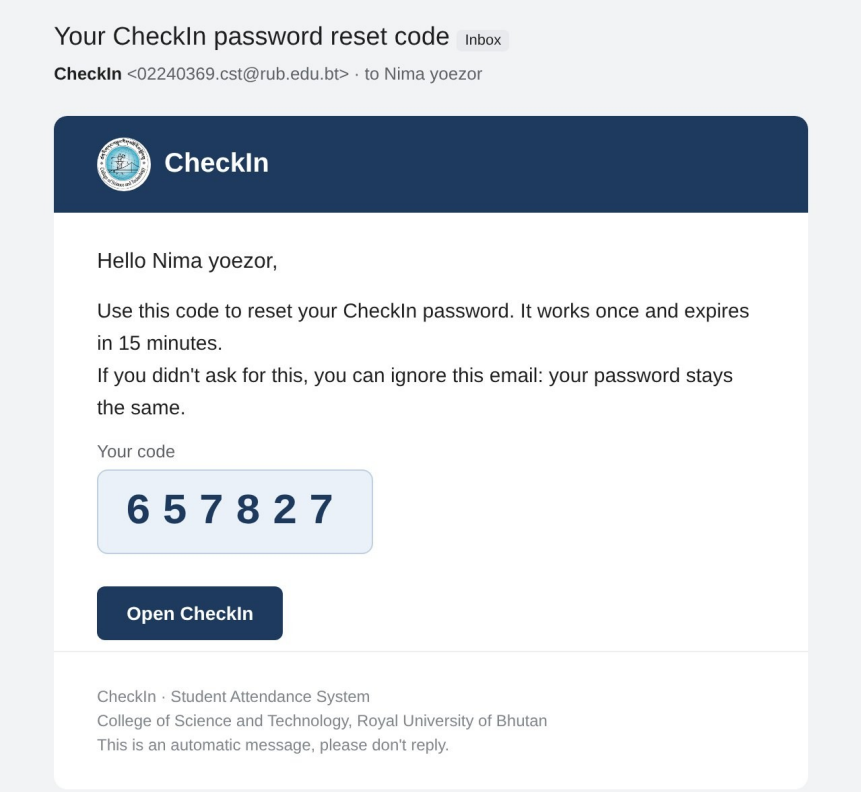


Figure 2 — the new design, here for a reset code

6. Pull requests

PR	Into	What it did
#61	dev	Send email through Brevo when BREVO_API_KEY is set; 7 unit tests; setup steps in docs/MOBILE.md, render.yaml and .env.example
#62	main	Released #61; GitHub Actions deployed the backend to Render after all checks passed
#63	dev	New email design; 4 unit tests (43 backend tests in total)
#64	main	Released #63 to the live site

7. For the team

- **Sanskar:** sign up again with your real student number; forgot password will then work for you.
- **Everyone:** make sure your account email is your real college email (Settings → Profile).
- **Get the latest code:** git checkout dev, then git pull origin dev. No new packages and no database changes on your side.

8. Next steps

- Replace the Brevo API key (it appeared in a screenshot during set-up) and update Render.
- Confirm the admin and management email addresses.
- Later: email verification at sign-up (a code sent to the email before the account can log in), so fake emails cannot create accounts.
- Turn on two-factor login for GitHub before 13 December 2026 (GitHub now requires it).